Census Workers & Follow-Up

Program: Census Questionnaire Assistance (CQA)
Topic Areas: Why a worker visits, what follow-up means, badge, employee verification, scam prevention, requesting a different time, avoiding repeated contact, what workers ask, how they record responses, letters or visits after responding, enumerator, nonresponse follow-up

Follow-Up Visits

Reason for Contact

Why is a census worker coming to my door?

A Census Bureau worker may visit to collect your response, ask about another address, confirm address or vacancy information, or ask follow-up questions. Workers may also update address lists or deliver questionnaires. You can verify the worker by checking their official government badge for a photograph, Department of Commerce watermark, and expiration date.

Keywords and Synonyms: census worker visit; home visit; follow-up; no response; household address; census worker; enumerator; field representative; in-person visit; doorstep visit; additional contact; reminder

Related/follow-up questions: How do I verify the worker?; What will the worker ask?; What if I already responded?

Worker Verification

Identity Verification

How do I verify that a census worker is legitimate?

Ask to see the worker's official government badge, which displays a photograph, Department of Commerce watermark, and expiration date. You may contact your regional Census office to verify the worker. Do not provide Social Security numbers, bank or credit-card account numbers, money, or donations.

Keywords and Synonyms: verify census worker; legitimate worker; ID badge; staff directory; regional office; verify; confirm; authenticate; legitimate; official; real; census worker; enumerator; field representative; photo identification; credentials

Related/follow-up questions: What ID should the worker carry?; What information will a worker never ask for?; What should I do if I suspect a scam?

Credentials

What ID does a census worker carry?

Every Census Bureau worker carries an official government badge displaying a photograph, Department of Commerce watermark, and expiration date. Government-issued equipment may also display an official Census logo. You may ask to see the badge and contact your regional Census office for verification.

Keywords and Synonyms: census worker ID; badge; photograph; watermark; expiration date; Census Bureau bag; ID; identification; credentials; Department of Commerce mark; valid-through date

Related/follow-up questions: How do I verify the worker?; Can I refuse until I verify them?; What if the badge looks suspicious?

Visit Scheduling

Return Visit

Can I ask a census worker to come back at a different time?

You cannot schedule an appointment with a census worker. If you are unavailable, the worker will leave information about responding online or by phone and may return at varying times.

Keywords and Synonyms: reschedule visit; come back later; convenient time; return visit; self-response; reschedule; change time; arrange another visit; come back; revisit; respond independently; complete directly

Related/follow-up questions: How do I contact the worker?; Can I respond online instead?; Why do workers make repeated visits?

Interview Content

Questions Asked

What information will a census worker ask for?

A census worker will ask about the people living or staying at your address on Census Day, including their names, sex, ages, dates of birth, relationships, Hispanic origin, and race. They will also ask whether the home is owned or rented and request contact information if follow-up is needed. They will not ask for Social Security numbers, bank or credit-card information, money, or donations.

Keywords and Synonyms: worker questions; household information; questionnaire; Social Security number; bank information; resident details; household answers; census questions; form; financial information; bank details; credit-card details

Related/follow-up questions: Can the worker complete the questionnaire with me?; Why are these questions asked?; How is my information protected?

Interview Assistance

Can a census worker complete my form for me?

Yes. A census worker can work with you to complete the census by asking questions and recording the answers you provide. Your responses are confidential, protected by federal law, and may be used only to produce statistics.

Keywords and Synonyms: complete questionnaire; worker assistance; interview; record answers; confidential; complete; fill out; answer; help from enumerator; interview support; enter responses; document answers

Related/follow-up questions: What will the worker ask?; Can someone else answer for the household?; How are my answers protected?

Prior Response

Continued Contact

I already responded. Why did I receive another letter or visit?

There may be a delay between your response and the Census Bureau's records being updated. A reminder may also have been mailed before your response was received. You may disregard future 2020 Census mailings, but speak with any census worker who contacts you. If you are unsure whether your response was submitted, you may respond again; procedures are in place to prevent duplicate counting.

Keywords and Synonyms: already responded; another letter; repeat visit; follow-up; confirm response; completed census; submitted response; repeat mailing; reminder; additional visit; confirm; verify status

Related/follow-up questions: How do I know my response was received?; Should I respond again?; Why is a worker visiting?

Census Terminology

Worker Role

What is a census enumerator?

A census enumerator is a Census Bureau worker who collects census responses. Enumerators may visit households that have not responded and work with residents to complete the census. They carry official government badges, and federal law requires the Census Bureau to protect the responses collected.

Keywords and Synonyms: enumerator; census worker; field representative; interview; collect responses; census taker; field interviewer; gather answers; record information

Related/follow-up questions: How do I verify an enumerator?; Why is an enumerator visiting?; What will they ask?

Follow-Up Operation

What is a Non-Response Follow-Up (NRFU)?

Non-Response Follow-Up, or NRFU, is the Census Bureau's process for contacting households whose census responses have not been received. A census worker may visit the address to collect the response and help ensure everyone is counted.

Keywords and Synonyms: Nonresponse Follow-Up; NRFU; no response; census operation; in-person interview; nonresponse follow-up operation; missing response; unreturned questionnaire; home interview; field interview

Related/follow-up questions: Why is a worker visiting?; What if I already responded?; Can I schedule another time?